Over time, Madhubani paintings became a part of festivities and special events like weddings. Slowly, this art attracted connoisseurs of art as many contemporary Indian artists took the art to the global stage. The traditional base of plastered mud wall was soon replaced by handmade paper, cloth and canvas. Since the paintings have been confined to a limited geographical range, the themes as well as the style are more or less the same.

Madhubani paintings were initially practised by different sects of people and hence the paintings were categorized into five different styles, such as Tantrik, Kohbar, Bharni, Godna, Katchni. But today, these five different styles have been merged by contemporary artists. The themes used in these paintings often revolve around Hindu deities like Krishna, Rama, Lakshmi, Shiva, Durga and Saraswati. Also, heavenly bodies like the Sun and the Moon often form the centerpiece of Madhubani paintings. The women of the village practised these paintings on the walls of their respective homes.

One can also find paintings based on the scenes from the royal courts and social events like weddings. The usage of geometrical patterns is apparent in these paintings. The fact that these complex mathematical patterns were used in Madhubani paintings makes them more intriguing and special.

These paintings are also known for their simplicity, for the brush and colours used are often derived from natural sources. While the paintings are largely made using powdered rice, colours are derived from turmeric, pollen, pigments, indigo, various flowers, sandalwood, and leaves of various plants and trees, etc. Also, many natural sources are combined and are processed to obtain the desired colours. The colours are often prepared by the artists themselves. If the artists come across empty spaces even after completing the painting, they usually fill up those empty spaces with the motifs of flowers, animals, birds and geometrical patterns. A double line is usually drawn as the border.

I. Note making

Title – Madhubani Painting

Note

1. Madhubani Painting
    - 1.1. Famous Indian art form
    - 1.2. Practised in Bihar & Nepal
    - 1.3. Content
        - 1.3.1. Particular occus
        - 1.3.2. Festivals
        - 1.3.3. Religious rituals etc.
    - 1.4. Colours
        - 1.4.1. Natural & plant based
        - 1.4.2. Bright, lampblack, ochre
    - 1.5. Instead of brushes use of :
        - 1.5.1. twigs, matchsticks & fingers
2. History and Evolution
    - 2.1. Origin – Bihar
    - 2.2. Referred in the Ramayana
    - 2.3. Women Paint on walls
    - 2.4. Evolution

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